Study the following pairs of sentences.

- Every citizen has to follow the rules of the society.
- All citizens have duties to perform.

In sentence 1, the subject 'every citizen' is of the singular Number. Hence the verb 'has' is also singular.

In sentence 2, the subject 'All citizens' is of the Plural Number. Hence the verb 'have' is also plural.

The verb should agree with the subject in Number and Person.

Concord or agreement denotes the agreement between the subject and the verb in a sentence. In general, a singular subject takes a singular verb and a plural subject takes a plural verb.

Read the following sentences.

- I go to school by bus.
- She goes to school by cycle.

The subject in sentence 1 is the pronoun 'I'. The verb agrees with the subject.

The subject in sentence 2 is a pronoun of the third person. The verb used is 'goes'.

Observe these sentences.

- Every man and every woman has duties to perform.
- Each boy and each girl was given a special prize.

When two singular nouns joined by 'and' are preceded by 'each' or 'every' the pronoun must be singular and the verb is also singular.

Read the sentences given below.

- The team is performing well.
- The staff are arguing about the dates of the tour programme.
- The class is organising a debate.
- The class are arguing over the issue.
- The jury has given its verdict.
- The jury are divided in their opinion.

Some of the collective nouns like 'class, cabinet, committee, board, jury, government, team and staff, take a singular verb when they are considered a unit, and a plural verb if the members are considered individually.

Observe the following sentences.

- The scenery of Kashmir is enchanting.
- All the information he gave me was false.
- All the furniture has been remodelled.
- Your hair has turned grey.
- His luggage is missing.

Nouns such as advice, alphabet, brick, clothing, furniture, information, luggage, poetry, scenery, thunder etc. are used only in the singular form and the verb that follows them is also singular. They are neither preceded by an indefinite article nor pluralised.

Look at the sentences given below.

- The Correspondent and Principal has called for a meeting.

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